Phil Genera

Infrastructure & Site Reliability Engineer

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Summary

Infrastructure engineer with 19 years at Google as an expert at the layer where capacity, traffic management, and failure domains meet. 15 years as an individual contributor and tech lead across diverse projects such as Electronic Health Record AI enrichment, planet-scale network load balancing, and Google Search with My Location, and an additional 4 years managing small infrastructure teams while still writing and shipping systems code, internally and externally. Built global load balancing for the L7 proxy carrying most storage bits in Google Cloud, and currently responsible for the reliability and safety of footprint operations across Google's internal continuous-delivery infrastructure. Has carried the pager for Google Search, YouTube, and Google Cloud Storage, and now trains an oncall team in the Incident Command System.

Technical

Java, Python, SQL, and C++, plus a long tail of domain-specific languages, with recent project work in Kotlin and Go. Linux systems work: nftables, policy routing and BGP, docker, snapraid, tcpdump. Reverse engineering Bluetooth devices. Agentic development with Claude Code and Antigravity. Global and regional software load balancing.

Experience

Google *Aug 2007 – Present*

Software Engineering Manager · Continuous Delivery Infrastructure *Feb 2024 – Present*

- Manage the team of 10 responsible for footprint operations (turn up, turn down, resize, move) across Google's CD infrastructure, which actuates the majority of the datacenter footprint and is on the critical path for Cloud expansion, AI capacity delivery, and efficiency.
- Led the team through a 79% reduction in failures of those footprint operations. Negotiated, defined and drove improvements to customer-centric SLIs, SLOs, and SLAs. Own the team's capacity supervision for footprint changes, which halts rollouts if overload is likely.
- The team sits at the interface between automated capacity planning and actuation. Moving footprint changes from operator-driven execution to automated, continuous actuation.
- Built agentic workflows for the team: automated bug filing, hands-off ticket fixes and code reviews, and automated root-cause analysis.
- Responsible for the oncall team in US-East. Training up new members, managing workload with the global team, and training the team on the Incident Command System annually.

Site Reliability Engineering Manager · Google for Clinicians *Jun 2022 – Feb 2024*

- Took over management of the team of 5 while continuing SRE work. The scope covered HIPAA and related compliance, infrastructure cost, project planning, customer relationships, and software engineering productivity.

Senior Site Reliability Engineer · Google for Clinicians *May 2021 – Jun 2022*

- SRE lead for Google's EHR search and longitudinal health-record product, Google for Clinicians, serving one of the largest hospital systems in the United States. Delivering streaming record updates, normalization, enrichment and analysis from bedside to serving in minutes.
- In addition to ETL indexing and search, the import pipeline added AI enrichments to physician notes and test results. Designed, built, and shipped load balancing and traffic management for the enrichment pipeline, delivering significantly higher reliability, lower operator toil, and resiliency against bad input.

Senior Software Engineer · Google Cloud Networking *Aug 2017 – May 2021*

- Built the first global load balancing for Google's internal L7 proxy (CloudPath, sitting between Google Cloud and Google production), a large and high-reliability component of the Google Cloud Platform.
- This load balancing project, with others, enabled traffic growth from XX Gbps to XX Tbps, with higher customer reliability, and lower cost.
- Landed features across the proxy and software-defined networking data and control plane (Orion, NSDI 2021).

Senior Site Reliability Engineer · Social SRE *May 2014 – Aug 2017*

- Moved to Cambridge, MA as tech lead for Social SRE, which ran the Gmail contacts database along with other graph indexing and storage services.
- When the team split into storage and graph halves, led the graph side: storage for all implicit and explicit social graph data, the Zanzibar authorization system (USENIX ATC 2019), and a service that ranked people by graph distance for features like Gmail address autocomplete.

Senior Site Reliability Engineer · YouTube & Storage Infrastructure *Nov 2012 – May 2014*

- Ran the West Coast SRE team operating YouTube's video transcoding pipeline and upload server, which went on to become Google Cloud Storage.
- As tech lead for the upload server, led the infrastructure response to the 2013 Snowden disclosures for the upload server and GCS.
- Production Readiness Review and SRE onboarding of YouTube Live Streaming infrastructure, which is shared between YouTube, Google Fiber, and YouTube TV.

Software Engineer · Mobile Search *Aug 2007 – Nov 2012*

- Invented *Search with My Location*, the blue dot on the mobile search home page, and co-authored the resulting patent with the product manager for the feature.
- Worked on google.com/m, particularly universal and local search, and curated the local search property for several years.
- Tech lead for mobile search infrastructure work, including launching ads on new mobile properties.
- 24x7 oncall rotation. Turned up capacity in response to emergencies, handled DoS configuration and response, and led the Production Readiness Review. Trained the SRE team founded to take on this, and other, mobile web services.

Software Engineer · Cisco Systems *Jul 2005 – Aug 2007*

- Built monitoring, diagnostics, and modular plugin tooling in Java for enterprise Linux telephony server clusters.

Personal Projects

wearvian · Wear OS phone key for Rivian R1 vehicles *2026*

- Wear OS app that functions as a Rivian phone key over Bluetooth LE: passive entry and drive enable by proximity, plus lock, frunk, liftgate, window, charge port, and climate commands.
- Reverse engineered the vehicle's phone-key protocol and documented: the pairing handshake, the authenticated ranging heartbeat that passive entry actually keys on rather than OS-level bonding, AES-GCM command framing, and the status stream that drives live lock, closure, charge, and range display.
- Built for offline operation and key custody. The watch holds no `INTERNET` permission and its private key never leaves the device, with a companion phone app performing the one-time cloud enrollment over the Wear OS Data Layer.

Home automation and network toys *ongoing*

- wallbox-ble attaches EV chargers to Home Assistant via bluetooth proxies.
- sundial-ntp is a solar-panel disciplined NTP refclock.
- mpubsub implements my defensive publication of brokerless Publish/Subscribe, and adds typing and encryption.
- Linux-routed home network with policy-based routing, one VLAN per resident, and an nftables trust-zone ruleset.
- Run IPv4 and IPv6 NTP servers in the public pool, served from AMPRNet (44/8) address space. Hundreds of RPS of time served.
- Built my own consoles, monitoring, and alerting for the systems I own, from woodstoves to furnaces to solar arrays.

Patents & Publications

- U.S. Patent 9,081,860, "Integration of Device Location into Search," with J. Siegel (filed 2008, issued 2015).
- "Self-Organizing Publish/Subscribe on the Network Edge," *Technical Disclosure Commons, Defensive Publications Series*, Art. 5601 (2022).

Education

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute *2001 – 2005*
B.S., Computer Science & Psychology

Additional

- Volunteers at the Boston Marathon as an Amateur Radio Operator at a medical tent, handling medical resupply and sweep bus traffic within the Incident Command System. *2016 – Present*
- Amateur radio (W1JV), atomic clocks, frequency measurement, and antique test equipment.
- Powerlifting, running, and endurance motorcycling. Home automation and heating with wood. Eagle Scout.